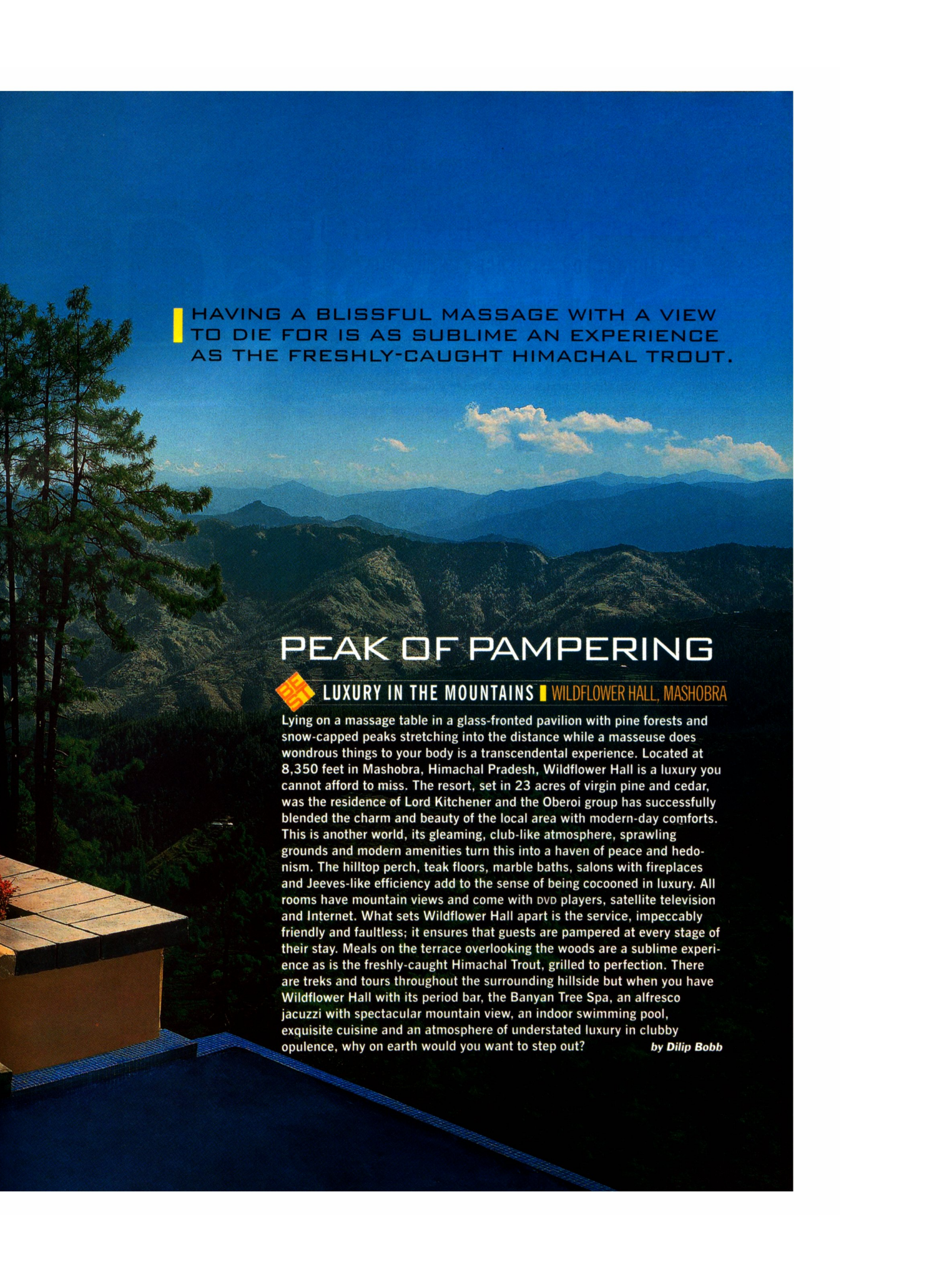




HAVING A BLISSFUL MASSAGE WITH A VIEW TO DIE FOR IS AS SUBLIME AN EXPERIENCE AS THE FRESHLY-CAUGHT HIMACHAL TROUT.

PEAK OF PAMPERING



LUXURY IN THE MOUNTAINS ■ WILDFLOWER HALL, MASHOBRA

Lying on a massage table in a glass-fronted pavilion with pine forests and snow-capped peaks stretching into the distance while a masseuse does wondrous things to your body is a transcendental experience. Located at 8,350 feet in Mashobra, Himachal Pradesh, Wildflower Hall is a luxury you cannot afford to miss. The resort, set in 23 acres of virgin pine and cedar, was the residence of Lord Kitchener and the Oberoi group has successfully blended the charm and beauty of the local area with modern-day comforts. This is another world, its gleaming, club-like atmosphere, sprawling grounds and modern amenities turn this into a haven of peace and hedonism. The hilltop perch, teak floors, marble baths, salons with fireplaces and Jeeves-like efficiency add to the sense of being cocooned in luxury. All rooms have mountain views and come with DVD players, satellite television and Internet. What sets Wildflower Hall apart is the service, impeccably friendly and faultless; it ensures that guests are pampered at every stage of their stay. Meals on the terrace overlooking the woods are a sublime experience as is the freshly-caught Himachal Trout, grilled to perfection. There are treks and tours throughout the surrounding hillside but when you have Wildflower Hall with its period bar, the Banyan Tree Spa, an alfresco jacuzzi with spectacular mountain view, an indoor swimming pool, exquisite cuisine and an atmosphere of understated luxury in clubby opulence, why on earth would you want to step out?

by Dilip Bobb